



MARKETING OPERATIONS PLAYBOOK

HOW TO UNF*CK YOUR MARKETING DATA

Stop flying blind. Build the data spine your marketing org needs to compute MER, ROAS, and real unit economics, without arguing with Revenue Ops about whose number is right.

24+

Marketing data silos inventoried inside

9

Metrics you can't trust without unification

4

Phase blueprint to collapse them

theinnovativenative.com
info@theInnovativeNative.com
(702) 582-5335
[@the.InnovativeNative](https://the.InnovativeNative)

IF YOU CAN'T ANSWER THESE IN 60 SECONDS, YOU'RE FLYING BLIND.

1. What was our **blended MER** last week, across every paid and organic channel?
2. What did **one paying customer** cost us, fully loaded, last quarter?
3. Which channel has the best **contribution margin**? Not the best ROAS. The best margin.
4. What's the **CAC payback** for cohort Q1, in months, by acquisition source?
5. Of the leads Marketing sent Sales last month, what percent **closed**, and what's the gap between Marketing's claim and Sales' record?

If you have to schedule a meeting to answer any of those, your marketing data lives in silos. You don't have a measurement problem. You have a **plumbing** problem. Most marketing teams build the stack the way most people build IKEA furniture: fast, reactive, screws left over. Then a year later they wonder why their CMO can't tell the CFO what one customer actually costs.

Your reports aren't lying. They're each telling the truth from inside a different room. The walls are the silos.

WHAT THIS HANDOUT IS

A tactical, executable blueprint specifically for the **marketing data layer**: ad platforms, web analytics, CRM, email, social, attribution, billing, and the fight between Marketing and Revenue Ops over whose number wins. You can run it in-house. You don't need a 6-figure consulting engagement.

WHAT THIS IS NOT

A general "data strategy" deck. A vendor pitch. A list of dashboards. We will name the silos, name the metrics that break, name the conflict between teams, and show you the order to fix it in.

THE MARKETING DATA SILOS. ALL OF THEM.

The average mid-market marketing org touches 25-40 tools. Each one is a silo unless something is actively un-siloing it. Here is the comprehensive map, organized by function. Tools listed are common examples, not endorsements.

SILO 01

Paid Media Platforms

Meta Ads, Google Ads, LinkedIn, TikTok, X, Pinterest, Reddit, DV360, The Trade Desk. Each one has its own conversion definitions, attribution windows, and audience IDs.

SILO 02

Web Analytics

GA4, Plausible, Adobe Analytics, Mixpanel, Amplitude, Heap, PostHog. Different event taxonomies, different sampling rules, different user IDs.

SILO 03

Tag Management

Google Tag Manager, Tealium, server-side tagging via Stape or Cloudflare Workers. Where ad-blocker losses become permanent.

SILO 04

CRM & Lead Database

HubSpot, Salesforce, Pipedrive, ActiveCampaign, Close, Copper. Where MQL → SQL → Opportunity definitions silently disagree with marketing's funnel.

SILO 05

Marketing Automation

HubSpot, Marketo, Pardot, Customer.io, Iterable, Braze, ActiveCampaign. Workflow data, lead scoring, lifecycle stages.

SILO 06

Email & SMS Platforms

Klaviyo, Mailchimp, ConvertKit, Beehiiv, SendGrid, Postmark, Attentive, Postscript. Open / click / unsubscribe / revenue-per-send.

SILO 07

Social Native Analytics

Meta Business Suite, LinkedIn Page Analytics, YouTube Studio, TikTok Analytics, X Analytics. Each measures reach and engagement differently.

SILO 08

Social Management Tools

Sprout, Hootsuite, Buffer, Later, Loomly, Metricool. Parallel post performance + click data that rarely matches native numbers.

SILO 09

Influencer & Affiliate

Aspire, Grin, CreatorIQ, Impact, PartnerStack, Rewardful, Refersion, FirstPromoter. Promo-code attribution and creator UTMs.

SILO 10

SEO & Content Intelligence

Ahrefs, Semrush, Moz, Sistrix, Surfer, Clearscope, Google Search Console, Bing Webmaster. Keyword universe, rank tracking, backlinks.

SILO 11

Attribution Platforms

Triple Whale, Northbeam, Rockerbox, Wicked Reports, Polar, Measured. Each model fights the native ad platforms by design.

SILO 12

Call & Form Tracking

CallRail, Invoca, Typeform, Tally, Jotform, Calendly. Where phone-driven and form-driven leads vanish from digital attribution.

THE SILOS, CONTINUED.

Silos thirteen through twenty-four. The deep cuts: post-purchase signals, the revenue truth layer, the sales-side stack, and the warehouse + BI tier that should be unifying all of it.

SILO 13

Reviews & Reputation

Trustpilot, G2, Capterra, Yotpo, Stamped, Okendo, Google Business Profile. Conversion lift signals that never reach marketing.

SILO 14

Session Recording & CRO

Hotjar, FullStory, LogRocket, Microsoft Clarity, VWO, Optimizely, Convert.com. Test data lives separately from the funnel.

SILO 15

Post-Purchase Surveys

Fairing, KnoCommerce, Enquire. "How did you hear about us?": often the truest channel signal, almost never wired into reporting.

SILO 16

Billing & Payments

Stripe, Recurly, Chargebee, Maxio, Paddle, Shopify, WooCommerce. The actual revenue source of truth. Almost never joined to channel.

SILO 17

Sales Engagement

Outreach, Salesloft, Apollo, Lemlist, Smartlead. Sales touches that change conversion rates marketing claims credit for.

SILO 18

Call Recording & QA

Gong, Chorus, Fathom. Sales conversation data that should feed back into ICP and creative. Never does.

SILO 19

Customer Support

Zendesk, Intercom, Front, Help Scout. Ticket volume by channel = early churn signal. Marketing rarely sees it.

SILO 20

CDP / Reverse ETL

Segment, Rudderstack, mParticle, Hightouch, Census. Supposed to unify, often becomes a 6th silo at half-completion.

SILO 21

Data Warehouse

BigQuery, Snowflake, Redshift, Databricks, Postgres. Where it should all land. The adoption gap is the entire problem.

SILO 22

BI & Dashboards

Looker, Tableau, Power BI, Mode, Sigma, Metabase, Looker Studio. Where duplicate metric definitions multiply.

SILO 23

Content & DAM

Asana, ClickUp, Notion, Airtable, Frame.io, Brandfolder, Bynder, Figma. Production data that never connects to performance.

SILO 24

Spreadsheets

Google Sheets, Excel, Numbers. The dark matter of marketing reporting. Where every "real" number actually lives.

THE 9 METRICS YOU CAN'T TRUST WITHOUT UNIFICATION.

Every metric below is a calculation that crosses silos. If the inputs don't reconcile, the output is a story, not a number. This is the math the C-suite is trying to make decisions from.

METRIC	FORMULA	WHY IT BREAKS UNDER SILOS
MER Marketing Efficiency Ratio	$\text{Total Revenue} \div \text{Total Marketing Spend}$	Spend lives in 5+ ad platforms. Revenue lives in Stripe/Shopify. No one joins them on a common timestamp + customer ID. Result: directionally wrong.
Channel ROAS Return On Ad Spend	$\text{Channel Revenue} \div \text{Channel Spend}$	Every ad platform claims credit for the same conversion. Over-attribution of 2x-3x is normal. Native ROAS adds up to more revenue than the company actually made.
Blended CAC Customer Acquisition Cost	$(\text{Mktg} + \text{Sales Cost}) \div \text{New Customers}$	Organic content cost is invisible. Tool subscriptions aren't allocated. Sales comp lives in HR, not in the CAC formula. Number reported is always too low.
LTV Lifetime Value	$\text{ARPA} \times \text{Gross Margin} \times \text{Avg Lifetime}$	ARPA in billing, margin in finance, lifetime needs cohort retention from product. Marketing rarely sees any of them.
CAC Payback	$\text{CAC} \div (\text{ARPA} \times \text{Gross Margin})$	Three siloed inputs. If any one is wrong, the months-to-payback is wrong. This is the number that decides if you can scale paid spend.
Contribution Margin / Channel	$\text{Rev} - \text{COGS} - \text{Variable Mktg}$	Requires SKU-level revenue, channel-attributed orders, and COGS by SKU. Almost no marketing team can compute this honestly.
Cohort Retention	$\text{Active in Mo N} \div \text{Active in Mo 0}$	Lives in product or billing. Marketing usually only sees aggregate churn, not retention by acquisition channel.
MQL → SQL → Won	% conversion at each stage	MQL defined by marketing, SQL by sales, Won by RevOps. Definitions don't agree. Stage rates can't be trusted across teams.
Pipeline Velocity	$(\text{Opps} \times \text{Win \%} \times \text{ACV}) \div \text{Cycle Length}$	Pulls from CRM stages, sales engagement, billing. If lifecycle stages drift, velocity drifts. Drives revenue forecasts that miss by 30%+.

A number you can't reconcile to a billing record is a number you can't bet money on.

REVENUE OPS VS MARKETING. THE KNIFE FIGHT NOBODY ADMITS TO.

Most data fights in growth-stage companies aren't about *tools*. They're about **definitions**. Marketing and Revenue Ops own different stores of truth and rarely agree on the words. Here's where the daggers come out.

THE WORD	MARKETING MEANS	REVOPS MEANS
Lead	Anyone who filled a form	Anyone with a known company that matches ICP
SQL	Marketing passed it to sales	Sales accepted it and worked it
Opportunity	Any deal in the CRM	Stage 2+, with budget, authority, need, timeline confirmed
Customer	Anyone who paid us once	Anyone live on a subscription past trial / first invoice
Attribution	Last non-direct click, 30-day window	Closed-won source from CRM "Lead Source" field
Channel Revenue	Whatever the ad platform reports	Whatever closed-won deals carry that source
Pipeline	Total open opp value	Stage 3+ weighted by win probability

THE FIX IS A DICTIONARY, NOT A TOOL

Before you buy another platform, hold a **90-minute definitions session** with Marketing + RevOps + Finance in the room. Write one definition per term. Publish it. Make it the only definition referenced in dashboards. Disagreements end when the document does.

REAL COST OF UNRESOLVED DEFINITIONS

A marketing team reporting 1,200 MQLs/mo with an 18% MQL→SQL rate is reporting **216 sales-ready leads**. If RevOps measures the same month and counts 78 accepted SQLs, somebody is wrong by 64%. That gap is six figures of misallocated headcount and ad spend per quarter.

01

AUDIT. MAP THE SILOS.

Goal: every system that produces a marketing-relevant number is inventoried, owned, and tied to a downstream metric.

STEP 1 / TOOL INVENTORY

For every platform across the 24 silos, capture:

- Tool name + vendor
- Owner (a real human, not a team)
- Monthly cost (paid + seats)
- Auth method (SSO? API key?)
- Data residency / region
- Has an API? Has a webhook?

STEP 2 / DATA FLOW MAP

For each tool, document:

- What it produces (events, records, files)
- Where the data goes *today*
- What the downstream consumer thinks it's getting
- Gap between #2 and #3

STEP 3 / IDENTIFIER AUDIT

The single most important step. Catalog every **person ID** and **account ID** that exists in your stack:

- Email (lowercase, trimmed)
- Anonymous web visitor ID
- CRM Contact ID, Account ID
- Stripe Customer ID
- App User ID
- Ad platform user IDs (CAPI / Conversions API)

If you can't translate one to another, you can't compute LTV.

STEP 4 / DEFINITION INVENTORY

Pull every dashboard, every saved report, every leadership slide from the last 90 days. List every **defined metric**. Note where the same word is calculated two different ways. This list becomes the input for Phase 3.

Most teams skip Step 3. They then spend six months on a CDP and still can't compute LTV by acquisition channel. The CDP can't fix what the identifier audit didn't surface.

OUTPUT OF PHASE 1

One spreadsheet, four tabs: **Tools · Flows · Identifiers · Definitions**. If it's not on one of those tabs, it isn't real. Time-box to **2 weeks**. Done beats perfect.

02

BUILD THE SPINE.

Goal: one queryable backend with every marketing event, every order, every cost, every customer, joined on identifiers you actually trust.

THE SPINE HAS 5 LAYERS. BUILD THEM IN ORDER.

#	LAYER	WHAT IT DOES	TOOLING THAT WORKS (PICK ONE)
1	Capture	Server-side events, with first-party identifiers, sent to every destination	Segment, Rudderstack, server-side GTM (Stape), custom Cloudflare Worker
2	Warehouse	Single store every other system reads from. Schema is yours, not the vendor's.	BigQuery, Snowflake, Postgres (Supabase), Databricks
3	Ingest	Pull from every silo on a schedule. Land raw. Transform later.	Fivetran, Airbyte, n8n, Stitch, custom scripts. Cheap silos: just n8n.
4	Model	Turn raw rows into modeled tables: fct_orders, fct_sessions, dim_customers, fct_ad_spend	dbt, SQLMesh, or raw SQL views in Postgres
5	Activate	Push modeled segments back to ad platforms, CRM, email tool	Hightouch, Census, custom n8n flows

CANONICAL MARKETING SCHEMA (MINIMUM VIABLE)

```

dim_customer(customer_id, email_hash, first_seen_at, first_touch_channel, first_touch_campaign,
first_paid_at, lifetime_revenue, lifetime_orders, status)
fct_session(session_id, anonymous_id, customer_id, started_at, channel, source, medium, campaign,
landing_page, device)
fct_order(order_id, customer_id, ordered_at, gross_revenue, discount, cogs, net_revenue, currency, channel,
campaign)
fct_ad_spend(date, platform, campaign_id, campaign_name, impressions, clicks, spend, native_conversions)
fct_touchpoint(touchpoint_id, customer_id, occurred_at, channel, campaign, position_in_path)

```

With those 5 tables, you can compute every metric on page 5. Without them, you can't.

03

ALIGN DEFINITIONS.

Goal: end the knife fight between Marketing and Revenue Ops. One dictionary, one set of dashboards, one number per question.

THE DEFINITIONS SESSION / AGENDA

1. 0:00 – 0:10 · Frame the cost of disagreement (use the 64% gap example from page 6).
2. 0:10 – 0:40 · Lifecycle stages: Lead → MQL → SAL → SQL → Opportunity → Customer → Expansion. One sentence per stage, signed by all three teams.
3. 0:40 – 0:55 · Attribution: agree on ONE primary model (last-touch, position-based, time-decay, MMM). Note exceptions, don't multiply them.
4. 0:55 – 1:10 · Source of truth per metric: revenue = billing system, spend = ad platforms, leads = CRM. No exceptions.
5. 1:10 – 1:25 · Cadence: weekly leadership view, monthly review, quarterly recalibration.
6. 1:25 – 1:30 · Write the doc. Get sign-off in the room. No "let me send notes."

SHARED KPI SET / THE MINIMUM 8

Blended MER

$$\text{Rev} \div \text{Spend}$$
Blended CAC

$$\text{Mktg} + \text{Sales} \div \text{New}$$
CAC Payback

$$\text{Months to breakeven}$$
90d LTV

$$\text{Cohort revenue 90d}$$
MQL→SQL

$$\text{Stage conversion \%}$$
SQL→Won

$$\text{Stage conversion \%}$$
Pipeline / \$ Spent

$$\text{Top-funnel efficiency}$$
Contribution / Channel

$$\text{Rev} - \text{COGS} - \text{VarMkt}$$

Eight numbers, reported the same way every Monday, by every team. That's the bar. If you can't hit it, you don't have a marketing measurement problem. You have an executive alignment problem.

04

OPERATE. KEEP IT CLEAN.

Goal: the spine doesn't decay. Owners, cadence, alerting, and a kill-switch for tool sprawl.

OWNERS

- **Marketing Data Owner:** one human, owns the spine end-to-end.
- **Per-silo Stewards:** one human per major tool; responsible for credentials, schema drift, vendor changes.
- **Definition Council:** Mktg + RevOps + Finance, meets quarterly, has authority to change any KPI definition.

CADENCE

- **Weekly:** the 8 KPIs reviewed, deltas explained.
- **Monthly:** cohort + channel deep dives.
- **Quarterly:** definitions review + tool audit.
- **Always:** alert when a tool's daily sync fails.

TOOL KILL-SWITCH

- Quarterly: each tool re-justified by its steward.
- If it doesn't write to the warehouse, it doesn't get renewed.
- If it has under 3 active users in 90 days, cancel.
- If two tools do the same job, kill the one with the worse API.

ALERTING

- Daily sync failure → Slack to data owner
- Identifier match rate drops >5% → Slack
- Spend >3σ above 28-day baseline → Slack
- Definition changed → email all three teams

UNIT ECONOMICS / WHAT THE CFO ACTUALLY WANTS EVERY MONDAY

QUESTION	NUMBER	SOURCE	HEALTH BAR
What did one customer cost?	CAC	$\text{fct_ad_spend} + \text{fct_customer}$	$< \text{LTV} \times 0.33$
How long to make it back?	Payback	$\text{CAC} \div \text{gross profit/mo}$	< 12 months
How much do we earn per \$1 spent?	MER	$\text{Stripe} \div \text{all spend}$	> 3.0 trailing 28d
Which channel actually pays?	Contribution / channel	$\text{fct_order} \times \text{COGS by channel}$	positive at week 4

THE 30-DAY AUDIT CHECKLIST.

Run this on your own stack this month. Each item is a yes/no with a measurable definition.

WEEK 1 / INVENTORY

- ☐ Every tool in the 24 silos has a named owner.
- ☐ Every tool has a documented monthly cost.
- ☐ Every tool's API status is captured (REST? webhook? export only?).
- ☐ Every dashboard in active use is screenshot-archived with its query.
- ☐ The "How did you hear about us?" survey is wired to billing.
- ☐ Every UTM in active campaigns is documented in a single sheet.

WEEK 2 / IDENTIFIERS

- ☐ Email-to-CRM-ID match rate is measured and >90%.
- ☐ CRM Contact has Stripe Customer ID on it.
- ☐ Web anonymous ID survives login (identify call fires).
- ☐ Server-side conversions API fires for every ad platform.
- ☐ First-touch channel is captured on customer creation.
- ☐ Email hashes (lowercase + trim) are computed consistently.

WEEK 3 / DEFINITIONS

- ☐ Lead / MQL / SAL / SQL / Opp / Customer each have one signed definition.
- ☐ Marketing-attributed revenue formula is written and agreed.
- ☐ "Spend" is defined to include or exclude tool subscriptions (your choice, just decide).
- ☐ Refund + chargeback treatment in revenue is defined.
- ☐ Attribution model is named, written, and dated.
- ☐ Lookback windows are explicit (e.g., 30-day click, 1-day view).

WEEK 4 / THE SPINE

- ☐ A warehouse exists and has at least one team writing to it weekly.
- ☐ fct_ad_spend exists with daily rows per platform per campaign.
- ☐ fct_order exists with channel + first-touch + customer_id.
- ☐ One dashboard reads from the warehouse, not from native tools.
- ☐ Daily sync failures alert one named human.
- ☐ The 8 KPIs are computed weekly and shared in one document.
- ☐ A retired-tools list exists. At least one tool has been cancelled.

Score yourself out of 25. Under 10 = you're flying blind. 10-17 = you have inputs, not insight. 18+ = your marketing engine has a working spine.

GLOSSARY. USE THE SAME WORDS.

MER	Marketing Efficiency Ratio. Total revenue ÷ total marketing spend, blended across all channels. A truth-telling number when native ROAS lies.	MTA	Multi-Touch Attribution. Cookie-based; impaired by iOS / browser changes; still useful directionally for paid channels.
ROAS	Return On Ad Spend. Channel revenue ÷ channel spend. Native platforms over-report due to claim overlap.	Incrementality	Lift caused by marketing vs the counterfactual no-marketing scenario. Geo holdouts and PSA tests are how you measure it honestly.
CAC	Customer Acquisition Cost. Fully loaded (paid + organic salary + tools + sales comp) ÷ net new customers.	MQL / SQL	Marketing / Sales Qualified Lead. Definitions vary; the point of Phase 3 is making yours not vary internally.
LTV	Lifetime Value. Average revenue per account × gross margin × expected lifetime (often capped at 24 or 36 months for sanity).	SAL	Sales Accepted Lead. The under-used middle step. Catches handoff drop-off between MQL and SQL.
ARPA	Average Revenue Per Account. Usually monthly. Inputs LTV.	Pipeline Velocity	(Open Opps × Win Rate × ACV) ÷ Cycle Length. Drives revenue forecast accuracy.
Payback	Months until cumulative gross profit from a customer equals their CAC. The number that decides whether you can scale paid spend.	CDP	Customer Data Platform. Unifies identity and events. Becomes a silo when half-deployed.
Contribution Margin	Revenue minus COGS minus variable marketing. By channel, by cohort, by SKU. The realest profitability lens at the unit level.	Reverse ETL	Push from warehouse back to operational tools. The "activate" step in Phase 2.
MMM	Marketing Mix Modeling. Statistical attribution that doesn't rely on cookies. Slower, more directional, less debatable.	Identity Graph	The mapping between anonymous IDs, email hashes, CRM contact IDs, and customer IDs. Without it, no LTV by channel.

THE ONE HABIT THAT BEATS EVERY TOOL

When someone says a metric, ask: "What's the formula and where does it pull from?" If you can't answer in one sentence, that metric is fiction. Make this question normal. Whole categories of silo damage disappear.

DATA THAT FLOWS = GROWTH THAT COMPOUNDS.

Disconnected marketing systems don't just create friction. They quietly destroy the math. If your dashboards can't answer the 5 questions on page 2 in under a minute, you're not making decisions. You're guessing in expensive shoes.

Use this blueprint to map your silos, build the spine, end the RevOps knife fight, and run the audit. Then your AI tools have something real to work on. Then your CAC payback is a number you can bet money on.

WANT ME TO RUN IT WITH YOU

I do this for operators running 7- and 8-figure businesses. We collapse the 24 silos into a single spine, write the definitions doc, build the dashboards, and hand you a marketing org that can compute its own unit economics every Monday before the standup.

[BOOK A DISCOVERY CALL](#)

EMAIL

info@theInnovativeNative.
com

DIRECT

(702) 582-5335

SOCIAL

@the.InnovativeNative

Most teams don't need more effort. They need less guessing.

